

Creamy carrot Soup with miso-tamarind swirl

This is a snazzy soup with a wonderful texture. You can make it as thick or as light as you like by adjusting the amount of liquid. The miso-tamarind sauce provides a beautiful **contrast in flavor** and color, as the orange soup is sweet and the reddish brown sauce has distinctive tang to it.

NOTE Make the Miso-Tamarind Sauce while your soup is cooking.

1 medium-large onion, coarsely chopped

1 cinnamon stick

1½ tablespoons vegetable oil

5 medium-large carrots, peeled and cut into chunks

1 large sweet potato, peeled and cut into chunks

5 cups vegetable stock or water [1.25L]

½ teaspoon grated nutmeg

⅛ teaspoon ground cloves

¾ teaspoon salt

Miso-Tamarind Sauce (recipe follows)

1. In a heavy-bottomed soup pot, **cook** the onion and cinnamon stick in the vegetable oil over medium heat until the onion is softened but not browned, about 5 minutes. Add the carrots, sweet potato, and vegetable stock. Bring to boil, reduce the heat to a simmer, cover, and cook until the carrots and sweet potatoes are soft, 15 to 20 minutes.
2. Remove from the heat and discard the cinnamon stick. In small batches, **ladle** roughly equal amounts of vegetables and stock into a blender or food processor. Puree until very smooth.
3. As each batch is pureed, **pour** it into a large bowl. When finished, return the pureed soup to the pot. Stir in the nutmeg, cloves, and salt.
4. To serve, reheat if necessary. Ladle the hot soup into bowls. **Decorate** each serving with a swirl of Miso-Tamarind Sauce.

SERVES 6

Miso-tamarind sauce

2 teaspoons maple syrup

1 teaspoon red miso or barley miso

1 teaspoon tamarind concentrate

3 garlic cloves, crushed through a press

1 tablespoon finely minced fresh ginger

½ cup vegetable stock or water [125ml]

1 teaspoon tomato paste

1. **Combine** the maple syrup, miso, tamarind, garlic, ginger, and 1 tablespoon of the stock in a small saucepan. Stir until smooth. Blend in the remaining stock.
2. Warm the sauce over medium-low heat. When it begins to bubble lightly, stir and continue to cook for 1 minute. **Stir** in the tomato paste. Simmer for 2 or 3 minutes until the sauce thickens. Remove from the heat and set aside to cool.
3. When cooled, **pour** the sauce into a squeeze bottle. If you don't have a squeeze bottle, pour the sauce from a measuring cup or drizzle it from a spoon. Design your own swirls over each individual cup of soup.

MAKES ABOUT ⅔ CUP [150ML]

